

Francis IT - Tech Doc

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Technical Manual: iPad & iPhone Not Booting / Power Logic

This technical guide outlines standardized protocols for diagnosing power-related failures and logic board inconsistencies in iOS and iPadOS devices. It is intended for hardware professionals performing component-level troubleshooting and system maintenance.

Phase 1: USB Multimeter Amperage Diagnostics

Using a USB-C or Lightning multimeter provides immediate feedback on the health of the charging logic (Tristar/Hydra IC) and the battery cells. Observe the current draw immediately upon connection.

Current Draw (Amps)	Probable Diagnosis	Recommended Action
0.00A - 0.05A	Open Circuit / Blown Fuse / Dead Tristar	Verify port cleanliness; inspect for Tristar/Hydra failure.
0.10A - 0.45A	Pre-charge Stage / Low Battery	Allow 15-30 minutes to see if current increases to normal levels.
0.90A - 2.10A	Fast Charging / Normal Operation	Logic board and battery handshake successful; charging circuit intact.
Fluctuating (0.01A - 0.50A)	Boot Loop / Battery Communication Error	Check battery health and test with a known-good component.

Phase 2: Force Restart & DFU Protocols

When devices fail to respond to standard power input, software-level logic hangs must be bypassed through hardware-level command overrides.

- Forced Restart: Essential for clearing power-state hangs that mimic hardware failure.
- DFU (Device Firmware Update) Mode: Critical for determining if a device is recognized by a host system when the display remains inactive.
- Recognition Logic: If a device draws approximately 0.05A and fails DFU recognition, the PMIC or CPU may be compromised.

Phase 3: Stress Testing & Verification

- Stability Check: Verification of charging logic and overall device stability is confirmed through stress tests.

- Current Monitoring: Sudden drops in current draw under high processing loads typically indicate a failing battery or a degraded power management rail.
- Reliability: Monitoring amperage during these tests ensures the repair's long-term reliability.

Technical Notes

- Always rule out physical obstructions by performing a port cleaning with an anti-static tool before proceeding to logic board diagnostics.
- Use consistent testing cables (known-good) to avoid false diagnostic results.